

Introduction to Your Plan

Welcome to the Sample Health Plan (PPO), administered by Sample Health Insurance Company. This Evidence of Coverage explains your rights and benefits as a member, including how to access care, what services are covered, and what you will pay for covered services. This is a general reference document; your actual coverage is governed by your enrollment agreement and plan documents. Please keep this document for your records and refer to it whenever you have questions about your coverage.

Important Contacts and Resources

Member Services: 1-800-555-0100, available Monday through Friday, 8:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m. local time. Nurse Advice Line: 1-800-555-0101, available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, for non-emergency health questions. Pharmacy Benefits Help Desk: 1-800-555-0102. You may also visit the member portal at member.samplehealthplan.example to view claims, find in-network providers, and download plan documents.

How the Plan Works

This plan uses a network of doctors, hospitals, and other health care providers. You may see any provider in the network without a referral. Visiting an in-network provider generally costs less than visiting an out-of-network provider. Some services, such as advanced imaging, certain surgeries, and inpatient hospital admissions, require prior authorization from the plan before you receive them. If prior authorization is not obtained when required, the plan may deny payment for the service, and you could be responsible for the full cost.

Your Rights and Responsibilities as a Member

As a member, you have the right to receive information about your coverage, to be treated with respect and dignity by network providers, to participate in decisions about your care, and to file a grievance or appeal if you disagree with a coverage decision. You are responsible for providing accurate information to your providers, following the treatment plans you agree to, paying your share of costs on time, and notifying the plan of changes to your address, dependents, or other insurance coverage.

Medical Benefits and Cost-Sharing

Cost-sharing is the amount you pay for covered services. A deductible is the amount you must pay for covered services before the plan begins to pay. A copayment (copay) is a fixed dollar amount you pay for a covered service, such as \$25 for a primary care visit. Coinsurance is a percentage of the cost of a covered service that you pay after you have met your deductible, such as 20% of the cost of an inpatient hospital stay. Your out-of-pocket maximum is the most you will pay in a plan year for covered services; once you reach it, the plan pays 100% of covered costs for the rest of the plan year.

Prescription Drug Coverage

Covered prescription drugs are organized into tiers. Tier 1 includes most generic drugs and generally has the lowest cost-sharing. Tier 2 includes preferred brand-name drugs. Tier 3 includes non-preferred brand-name drugs. Tier 4 includes specialty drugs, which typically require prior authorization and have the highest cost-sharing. A complete list of covered drugs, called the formulary, is available on the member portal. Some drugs may require step therapy, meaning you must try a lower-cost alternative first.

Preventive Care and Wellness Benefits

Preventive services recommended by national clinical guidelines, such as annual wellness visits, routine immunizations, and certain cancer screenings, are covered at no cost to you when received from an in-network provider, and the annual deductible does not apply to these services. Preventive care helps detect health issues early and is an important part of maintaining your overall health.

Emergency and Urgently Needed Care

Emergency services are covered anywhere in the world, whether or not the provider is in-network, because emergencies cannot always be anticipated. If you believe you are experiencing a medical emergency, call 911 or go to the nearest emergency room. Urgently needed care is for a condition that is not an emergency but requires prompt attention, such as a minor injury or sudden illness; urgent care centers typically have shorter wait times than emergency rooms and lower cost-sharing.

What Is Not Covered (Exclusions)

This plan does not cover cosmetic procedures that are not medically necessary, experimental or investigational treatments not approved by recognized medical authorities, services received outside of a medical emergency from providers outside the plan's network without prior authorization, and personal comfort items during a hospital stay. A complete list of exclusions and limitations is available in your plan's benefit certificate.

Filing a Grievance or Appeal

If you are dissatisfied with the quality of care you received, you may file a grievance with the plan at any time. If the plan denies a claim or a request for prior authorization, you have the right to file an appeal within 180 days of the denial notice. The plan will respond to a standard appeal within 30 days and to an expedited appeal, for urgent situations, within 72 hours. If your appeal is denied, you may have further appeal rights, including an independent external review.

Ending Your Membership

You may end your membership in this plan during the annual open enrollment period or during a special enrollment period triggered by a qualifying life event, such as marriage, the birth of a child, or loss of other coverage. The plan may also end your membership if you no longer meet eligibility requirements, move outside the service area, or fail to pay required premiums after a grace period.

Definitions of Important Terms

Deductible: the amount you pay for covered services before the plan starts to pay. Copayment: a fixed amount you pay for a covered service. Coinsurance: a percentage of the cost of a covered service you pay after meeting your deductible. Out-of-pocket maximum: the most you will pay for covered services in a plan year. Prior authorization: approval from the plan required before you receive certain services. Network: the group of providers who have agreed to provide services to plan members at negotiated rates.